

Table 13: Claude 88000 summaries of Janika Oz’s *A History of Burning*.

Strategy	Summary
Hier	In 1972 in Uganda, Latika and Arun, an Indian couple with a baby son named Harilal, receive a mysterious letter delivered by a young Ugandan soldier. The country is under the dictatorship of Idi Amin, who has ordered all Asians to leave Uganda within 90 days. Latika hides the letter from Arun and reads it alone, discovering it is an order from Amin to immediately stop publishing their underground newspaper Jicho, which has been printing anti-government articles. Latika has secretly kept the paper going against Arun’s wishes, as he argues it endangers their family while she believes justice is more important than their personal safety. Latika hides the letter out of fear of Arun’s reaction and thrill at the power it places in her hands, as the soldier assumed Arun was in charge, not realizing she runs Jicho. Her secrecy over the paper and letter signals a rupture in trust between them, as Arun wants to protect his family but Latika is singleminded in her activism, sparking conflict in their marriage. With the expulsion order, this clash between family and justice becomes increasingly fraught. The story then jumps ahead to 1992 in Canada, where Rajni and Vinod are searching at night for their missing son Hari after a protest rally turned violent. They find their daughters Mayuri, Kiya and granddaughter Meetu waiting, but Hari is still missing. Earlier that day, Hari went to the rally despite his family’s concerns. His friend Solomon was also there. When police arrived, tear gas was released and protesters fled as confrontations broke out. Hari lost Solomon in the chaos. Unable to find Hari, Rajni realizes they should go home, as home is where her family is, not any physical place. Just then, Mayuri spots them and brings them to their shop, which has been set on fire during the unrest. As the family watches the burning shop, Hari appears, having made his way back alone. Angry they are just standing there, he wants to try saving the shop, but Rajni says calmly it’s done; they know how to rebuild. Vinod agrees, saying now is the time to rest. The fire destroys the shop but leaves the ground ready for something new. Hari realizes his family has persevered, almost whole. Though they will have to start over with the shop gone, they will insist on something better next time rather than accept injustice. Rajni reflects on how they have migrated from India to Africa to Canada, realizing anywhere can feel like home if her family is together. After so much loss, they made it here united. While the shop is destroyed, their family remains strong. In summary, the story spans 20 years and two families, exploring how broader political conflicts intertwine with and impact family relationships. In 1970s Uganda, rising political tensions strain the marriage of activists Latika and Arun as they clash over family versus justice. Two decades later in 1990s Canada, the family of Rajni and Vinod draw closer amidst violent unrest, losing their shop but keeping their bond intact. Despite different places and contexts, both families experience the complex dynamics between individual ideals, family ties, and turbulent political realities. Ultimately they share the resilient hope that as long as their family is together, they have arrived home.
Inc	In 1972, Latika and her husband Arun live in Kampala, Uganda with their baby son Harilal. Latika runs an underground newspaper called Jicho with her friend Daniel, who has recently disappeared likely due to being critical of dictator Idi Amin’s regime. On the morning of August 4th, Amin declares over the radio that Asians must leave Uganda within 90 days. Latika’s family is in shock, trying to understand if they will be impacted as Ugandan citizens. Her sister Mayuri is away studying medicine in India. Latika’s father Vinod goes to pray at the temple and sees a dead body in the river, then finds a copy of Jicho which he destroys out of fear. The family spends days waiting in endless lines to try to get paperwork to leave, selling possessions, and being humiliated by soldiers. Latika’s parents are unable to secure clearance to leave yet. One day, soldiers line up and shoot Asians on the street, but Vinod is spared because he has a red mark on his forehead from praying. He sees his childhood friend Moses, now a soldier, who lets him go. Meanwhile, a soldier delivers a letter to Latika ordering her to cease publication of Jicho, but she hides it from Arun. As the deadline to leave looms, Latika reflects on her tense relationship with Arun over her activism and thinks about why she chose him. She resolves to continue publishing the banned paper in secret, seeing it as the purpose of her life. On the night of September 9th, the eve of the expulsion deadline, soldiers break into Latika and Arun’s apartment. They beat and arrest Arun while Latika screams and clings to their baby Harilal. The next day, Latika’s parents and sister Kiya come to collect Harilal so they can flee the country together. But despite their pleas, Latika refuses to leave Kampala without Arun, entrusting them with caring for her son. Heartbroken, the family leaves Latika behind as they make their way to the airport and eventually resettle as refugees in Canada. Now alone in Kampala, Latika descends into despair searching for Arun. She publishes one final defiant issue of Jicho before her supplies run out. An old friend named Adroa visits and is shocked to find Latika still there. Seeing the toll it has taken on her, he encourages Latika to leave Uganda and make a new life elsewhere. Latika finally resolves to do so, boarding a plane to London with the other remaining Asian refugees.

Table 14: Mixtral 2048 summaries of Janika Oz’s *A History of Burning*.

Strategy	Summary
Hier	“A History of Burning” by Janika Oza is an intricate, multigenerational saga that explores themes of intergenerational trauma, resilience, identity, and colonial exploitation across time, spaces, and continents. The narrative spans from Jamnagar, Gujarat, to Kenya, Uganda, and Canada, weaving together the lives of several characters whose experiences intersect and diverge amidst political upheaval, personal sacrifices, and cultural expectations. The story begins in Jamnagar during a severe drought, where thirteen-year-old Purbhai struggles to find work. Driven by his mother’s encouragement, he embarks on a journey to Jamnagar and meets a mysterious merchant who leads him to work on a dhow sailing towards an unknown destination. Meanwhile, in Kenya, Sonal is a young Indian woman living with her family. When Purbhai, now a refugee in Kenya, is employed by Sonal’s father, the two form a deep bond as they navigate their lives together amidst political turmoil and personal sacrifices. Purbhai’s past unveils his harrowing experiences as an indentured laborer in East African colonies and the guilt he feels over the circumstances that led him to Kenya. Simultaneously, the narrative explores Sonal’s losses, including her brothers who perished during migration, and her struggle to forge connections with her family and her new home. The narrative intertwines with Rajni’s story during her migration from Uganda to Canada, following Idi Amin’s expulsion of Asians from the country. Rajni, a resilient woman, grapples with her new life in a cold and foreign country while mourning the loss of her daughter, Latika. The lives of these characters continue to intersect and diverge in Toronto, revealing a rich tapestry of experiences, hopes, and triumphs despite the adversities they encounter. Other characters play significant roles in shaping the narrative. Vinod, an Indian immigrant, navigates cultural assimilation, identity, and family expectations in Canada. Kiya, Rajni’s daughter, deals with her resentment towards her sister Mayuri, who left the family during their time of need. Hari, the Patels’ son, and his friend Solomon grapple with the consequences of their actions during a protest against racism. Through the characters’ experiences, the narrative explores the intricate connections between historical events and their impact on the characters’ lives. From the struggles of poverty in Jamnagar, the brutal labor conditions in East African colonies, to the racial tensions and political turmoil in Uganda, the story emphasizes the power of resilience, human connections, and the complex nature of identity forged amidst shifting political alliances and dislocations. In Toronto, Kiya joins the army, and the family grieves after Latika’s disappearance. Hari and Solomon confront the consequences of their actions during a protest against racism. The non-linear storytelling features past and present flashbacks, providing a rich context for the characters’ experiences. Despite the non-linear narrative, the story ultimately presents a consistent and chronological account of the characters’ lives and their struggles to forge a sense of belonging amidst adversity. In conclusion, “A History of Burning” is a compelling exploration of characters’ lives woven together throughout history, emphasizing the profound power of resilience, human connections, and the complex nature of identity. By engaging with themes such as colonial exploitation, community, survival, and identity, the story forges a rich and imaginative world that touches on the lives of Purbhai, Sonal, Rajni, Vinod, Kiya, Mayuri, and others, as they navigate across continents and navigate an intricate web of cultural expectations, personal sacrifices, and political upheaval.
Inc	The story follows the Purbhai family, whose roots lie in India but have ties to Kenya, Uganda, and now Canada. The family includes Rajni and Vinod, their sons Hari and the late Arun, daughter Mayuri, Rajni’s uncle Nanu, reemerged sister Kiya, and her son Harilal. In 1991, Hari bonds with friends Marcus, Solomon, and Sami over shared experiences and basketball. He grapples with Arun’s death and the revelation of a long-lost sister, Latika. The family unites to discuss Latika and commemorate Arun. Hari investigates the Ugandan Asian expulsion but discovers limited information. In 1992, Hari turns 19 and forms a close friendship with Marcus, Solomon, and Sami. Ignited by the Rodney King beating and the deaths of Raymond Lawrence and Michael Wade Lawson, he joins community protests, driven by his pursuit of justice and skepticism of official narratives. Together, they restore a vandalized local basketball court. Hari’s reflections on family dynamics lead him to play basketball with Solomon instead of completing a report. Parallely, Rajni navigates Vinod’s deteriorating health while embracing his desire for privacy. Together, they face his physical decline. Rajni’s past reemerges while she raises her concerns for Hari’s safety during protests. She understands the importance of supporting their causes despite her fears and apprehensions. At the demonstration, Hari advocates for justice and unity. When tensions escalate, he gets separated from his friends. Rajni turns to prayer for Hari’s safety, prompted by reminiscences of her past. Upon discovering Hari’s disappearance, the family unites in searching for him. After the protest, disoriented and lost, Hari reconnects with his friends, who assist him in returning home. Aware of Hari’s safety, the family reconvenes to make sense of the day’s events, solidifying their unity and commitment to fighting for justice. The narrative intertwines Rajni, Hari, and their friendships as they confront their histories, find comfort in unity, and sustain their roots amid political strife. Acclaimed writers like Sharon Bala, Ngig’ wa Thiong’o, and Gaiutra Bahadur enrich the storyline with dedicated support, historical context, and scholarship. Mentors and writing programs bolstered Hari’s belief in his writing abilities. The Purbhai family’s story spans generations and continents, with each member experiencing their own trials and triumphs. They carry the weight of their family legacy and the history of their ancestors. Through it all, the family remains united, finding strength in their shared experiences and their commitment to fighting for justice and equality. The story emphasizes the importance of community, collectivism, and solidarity, inviting readers to reflect on who is included and excluded in their own spheres.

Table 15: LLaMA 2 2048 summaries of Janika Oz’s *A History of Burning*.

Strategy	Summary
Hier	In 1898, a young boy named Pirbhai leaves his home in India in search of work. He meets a merchant who offers him a job on a boat heading to an unknown destination. Along with several other men, Pirbhai embarks on the journey. In the late nineteenth century, Pirbhai leaves India to find work on a ship bound for Africa. Once aboard, he meets Jameel, a fellow countryman, and together they endure the hardships of life at sea. After several weeks, the ship arrives in Mombasa, Kenya, and Pirbhai and Jameel are among those who disembark. They are taken to a nearby railway camp, where they are put to work building a railway line through the jungle. Pirbhai struggles to adjust to life in the camp, where he is plagued by memories of his family back home and the guilt of being unaware of the true nature of his employment. Despite these challenges, he finds solace in the company of his fellow workers and in the simple pleasures of life in the camp. In 1956, Pirbhai and Rakesh work as coolies in India under the British Empire. They are tasked with burning down abandoned huts in the countryside, and Pirbhai feels conflicted about participating in such violence. In 1956, the day their third granddaughter Kiya was born, they find a portrait of Queen Elizabeth scattered in the street. They were on their way to make a donation at the local Asian school, whose roof was rusted and collected magpie droppings. Mayuri, a young Ugandan woman, receives a call from her friend Kiya in 1990. Pirbhai leaves India in search of work in 1898. He meets a merchant who offers him a job on a boat heading to an unknown destination. Along with several other men, Pirbhai embarks on the journey. In the late nineteenth century, Pirbhai leaves India to find work on a ship bound for Africa. Once aboard, he meets Jameel, a fellow countryman, and together they endure the hardships of life at sea. After several weeks, the ship arrives in Mombasa, Kenya, and Pirbhai and Jameel are among those who disembark. They are taken to a nearby railway camp, where they are put to work building a railway line through the jungle. Pirbhai struggles to adjust to life in the camp, where he is plagued by memories of his family back home and the guilt of being unaware of the true nature of his employment. Despite these challenges, he finds solace in the company of his fellow workers and in the simple pleasures of life in the camp. In 1956, Pirbhai and Rakesh work as coolies in India under the British Empire. They are tasked with burning down abandoned huts in the countryside, and Pirbhai feels conflicted about participating in such violence. In 1956, the day their third granddaughter Kiya was born, they find a portrait of Queen Elizabeth scattered in the street. They were on their way to make a donation at the local Asian school, whose roof was rusted and collected magpie droppings. Mayuri, a young Ugandan woman, receives a call from her friend Kiya in 1990. Pirbhai leaves India in search of work in 1898. He meets a merchant who offers him a job on a boat heading to an unknown destination. Along with several other men, Pirbhai embarks on the journey. In the late nineteenth century, Pirbhai leaves India to find work on a ship bound for Africa. Once aboard, he meets Jameel, a fellow countryman, and together they endure the hardships of life at sea.